

Pavel Bukengolts

Head of Product Design | Design Operations | Team Leadership | Human-Centered AI | Accessibility
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Summary

Award-winning senior product design leader with a track record of building teams, shaping UX strategy, and shipping complex enterprise platforms across healthcare, fintech, SaaS, and consulting environments. Combines hands-on product design, discovery, prototyping, and cross-functional leadership to turn ambiguous requirements into intuitive, accessible, and measurable product experiences. Brings added strength in design systems, accessibility, and AI-enhanced workflows that improve speed without weakening craft.

Selected Executive Impact

- Shipped the Team Capability Engine MVP from concept to pilot in under 90 days, securing 3 beta pilots through hands-on product strategy, UX, and AI-assisted delivery.
- Unified fragmented digital experiences across 70+ web properties, reducing developer dependency by 60% and establishing a more consistent multi-brand UX foundation.
- Architected an enterprise design system spanning 800+ digital properties, cutting production time by 40%, reducing vendor dependency costs by 50%, and standardizing UX patterns and WCAG 2.2 accessibility at scale.
- Improved product adoption and engagement through discovery, prototyping, and design leadership, contributing to 30% adoption lift and 30% engagement lift across key initiatives.

Experience

Head of Product Design & Strategy

UX Design Lab, LLC | *Nashville, TN*

04.2024 – Present

- Lead end-to-end product design, UX discovery, and rapid prototyping for enterprise and growth-stage clients, translating complex requirements into product direction, user flows, and aligned stakeholder decisions.
- Designed and shipped the MVP for Team Capability Engine, leading product strategy, UX, and AI-assisted delivery from concept to pilot, securing 3 beta pilots in under 90 days.
- Accelerated research synthesis, prioritization, prototyping, and delivery by integrating applied AI into workflows, reducing client timelines by 60% while maintaining usability and human-centered design standards.
- Architect design systems, governance models, and delivery frameworks that help clients sustain quality, accessibility, and speed beyond the initial engagement.

Lead of Enterprise Design Operations & Strategy

Abbott | *Remote*

01.2022 – 04.2024

- Led UX standards, visual coherence, and experience quality across the U.S., LATAM, APAC, and EMEA, aligning distributed internal and agency teams around a shared design language.
- Architected the interaction patterns, component logic, and UX principles for an enterprise design system spanning Figma, Storybook, and Adobe Experience Manager, supporting adoption across 800+ digital properties.
- Shaped the system into a scalable product foundation that reduced production time by 40% and vendor dependency costs by 50%.
- Embedded WCAG 2.2 accessibility into the system's design rules and review process, reducing critical accessibility defects by 18% before development and improving enterprise audit readiness.

VP of User Experience and Web Management

Protective Life | *Remote*

01.2020 – 11.2021

- Directed UX modernization across 70+ web properties, mapping fragmented multi-brand journeys into a more cohesive, accessible experience architecture.
- Built the UX function from a single contributor into a multi-team design organization, mentoring designers and establishing stronger standards for research, interaction design, and cross-functional collaboration.
- Led prototyping, design reviews, and stakeholder alignment to secure executive buy-in for a unified design language across digital products.
- Reduced developer dependency by 60% through clearer design patterns, reusable components, and stronger design-to-engineering workflows.

Director of User Experience

DePalma Studios | *Nashville, TN*

10.2017 – 01.2020

- Directed UX strategy and hands-on product design across healthcare, fintech, and SaaS clients, translating business goals into intuitive, accessible digital products.
- Facilitated discovery workshops, created high-fidelity prototypes, and led design reviews that contributed to a 30% increase in user engagement.
- Used Lean UX and Agile methods to improve prioritization, reduce delivery friction, and increase team velocity by 25%.
- Partnered with executives, product teams, and engineering leaders to translate business goals into product direction, user flows, and scalable experience frameworks.

Senior HCI Engineer (Principal UX Designer)

Sitecore Inc. – Platform Innovation and Engineering | *Remote*

04.2013 – 08.2017

- Served as the principal design lead for advanced marketing applications within Sitecore's innovation group, shaping personalization tools that increased user adoption by 30%.
- Designed the core UX architecture and interaction models for a large-scale platform proof of concept, establishing foundational design rules used by visual design and engineering teams.
- Worked across product, engineering, and design stakeholders to turn emerging platform concepts into usable, scalable product experiences.

Recognition, Teaching & Publications

- Top 3 Finalist, Tech Educator of the Year, *Greater Nashville Technology Council Awards*
- Top 100 World's Most Influential Mentors, *ADPList*
- Contributing Author, *UX Magazine*, published articles on UX strategy, AI-enhanced workflows, accessibility, and design systems
- Adjunct Professor of UX, UI & AI, *Nossi College of Art & Design*

Education

Computer and Digital Communication Science | Master of Science

Belarus State University of Informatics and Electronics

Focus: Human Factors, Ergonomics

Graphic Design | Bachelor of Arts

School of Visual Arts

Skills

Leadership & Strategy: Product Design Leadership, UX Strategy, Design Direction, Team Development, DesignOps, Governance, Change Management, Service Design, Lean UX, Agile Delivery

Research & Experience Design: Discovery, Information Architecture, Interaction Design, Prototyping, Usability Testing, Evaluative Research, Inclusive Design, WCAG 2.2 Compliance

AI & Systems: Human-Centered AI, AI-Assisted Workflows, AI Governance, Prompt Engineering, Applied AI in Research and Prototyping

Tools: Figma, Storybook, Adobe Experience Manager, Miro, Sketch, UserTesting, Jira, Confluence